

Matthew Smart — Cardinal Health

Call Prep | Thu May 14, 10:30 AM CDT | 30 min | Teams

The Situation

Matthew is **Director of AI Strategy and Business Transformation** at Cardinal Health, based in **Lewisville, TX** (local). He found Improving by Googling and filling out the training contact form on May 7. Bryan Crawford routed it to you because you have prior Cardinal Health history (board meeting, December).

This is a **warm inbound lead** — he came to us. He knows what he wants. Don't over-sell; listen and qualify.

Teams link: <https://teams.microsoft.com/meet/261701306033002?p=MthWfrAf9clkBgzGjE>

Who Is Matthew Smart

Title	Director, AI Strategy & Business Transformation
Company	Cardinal Health (CAH) — Fortune 15, ~\$200B revenue, healthcare distribution + Sonexus biopharma services
Location	Lewisville, TX
Email	matthew.smart01@cardinalhealth.com
Phone	678-492-2892
LinkedIn	linkedin.com/in/matthewsmart
Credentials	MCMP, MSP, CAITL — certified in change management, Microsoft platforms, and AI transformation

He sits inside the **AI Center of Excellence** at Cardinal Health and is expanding it. His mandate: drive AI-powered productivity and business transformation across the organization.

What He Asked For (Verbatim)

"We are located in Lewisville. I am looking for customized productivity sprints workshops for leaders to solve specific use cases with the AI tools we have access to. Copilot 365 but can only create local agents not Copilot Studio. Some of us have access to Notebook LM and the Gemini researcher and idea agent. A big use case for us is finding a way to streamline RFPs using Copilot and/or Notebook LM. Setting up directories."

Decode:

- He has **Microsoft 365 Copilot** but is locked out of Copilot Studio (likely licensing or IT governance)
- Some users have **Notebook LM** and **Gemini** — mixed tool environment, not fully standardized
- **Biggest pain:** RFP process is manual and slow — wants AI to streamline it
- **Format he wants:** Workshop-style, hands-on, customized to their actual use cases — not generic training

Cardinal Health Context

Cardinal Health is a **Fortune 15 healthcare distribution and services company** (~\$200B revenue). The Sonexus division he linked in the agenda handles **patient access and adherence** for biopharma manufacturers — think hub services, prior auth automation, benefits verification, patient onboarding for specialty drugs.

Why this matters for the call: Sonexus is growing 30%+ in FY2026 and just won the Dupixent My Way program (one of the largest patient support programs in the industry). They're scaling fast and dealing with **high-volume manual processes** — RFPs, onboarding, workflow automation. That's exactly where AI productivity workshops create immediate ROI.

AI posture at Cardinal Health: They've publicly committed to AI for productivity and supply chain optimization. They have an internal AI CoE (Matthew's team). Leadership is supportive but adoption is uneven — classic "islands of AI" problem.

His Likely Pain Points

1. **RFP process** — mentioned explicitly. Likely time-intensive, repetitive, multiple contributors. Copilot + structured prompting can compress turnaround significantly.
2. **Tool fragmentation** — Copilot 365 + Notebook LM + Gemini = three tools, inconsistent adoption, no playbook
3. **Leader capability gap** — wants workshops *for leaders*, not just individual contributors. Exec buy-in and skill-building, not just end-user training
4. **IT governance constraints** — can't use Copilot Studio, which limits agent-building. He's working around it with local agents
5. **Scale** — Sonexus is growing fast. Manual processes that worked at smaller scale are breaking

Improving's Fit

What He Needs	What Improving Delivers
Customized AI workshops for leaders	Executive AI Workshop format — already delivered (DRC May 21 is yours)
RFP streamlining with Copilot	Microsoft practice + AI integration — direct capability
Practical, use-case-driven	"The Enterprise Shift" — real workflows, not theory
Local (Lewisville / Dallas area)	Improving Dallas office, 5 min from Lewisville
Hands-on productivity sprints	Workshop + implementation, not just slides

Microsoft angle: Improving has an active Microsoft SME&C relationship (John Yurewicz) and Nada Ungvarsky as Alliance Partner Manager. If this scales, there's a co-sell angle.

Agenda Suggestion (30 min)

Time	Topic
0–5 min	Set context — what brought him here, what does "streamline" mean to him

5–15 min	Understand the RFP use case in depth — who's involved, current state, what tools they have
15–22 min	Share how Improving approaches this — workshop format, what outcomes look like
22–28 min	Scope next step — pilot workshop, discovery session, or formal proposal
28–30 min	Close on next action and timeline

Questions to Ask

- Walk me through the RFP process today — how many people, how long does it take, where does it get stuck?
- Are you locked out of Copilot Studio at an IT level, or is it a licensing decision? (Affects what we can build)
- Who else is in the room when AI productivity decisions get made — is this you, or do you have a VP/CTO sponsor?
- What does success look like in 90 days? One process improved, or broader adoption?
- Have you run any AI workshops internally already, and what worked or didn't?

Watch-Outs

- **Scope creep risk:** He may want a broad "AI transformation" engagement. Keep the conversation anchored to specific use cases — start narrow, prove value, expand.
- **Copilot Studio constraint:** Don't over-promise on agent-building without understanding the IT landscape. Ask before committing.
- **Budget authority:** Director title suggests he can influence but may need VP approval for a significant engagement. Qualify early.
- **Mixed tool environment:** Notebook LM and Gemini alongside Copilot suggests the org isn't fully standardized on Microsoft. Don't assume M365-only.

Possible Next Steps

1. **Discovery workshop** — half-day session with 4–6 leaders, map 3 use cases, pick 1 to pilot
2. **RFP pilot sprint** — focused 2-day engagement on just the RFP workflow; measurable output
3. **Executive AI Workshop** — bring him and 3 peers to the May 21 DRC workshop as a preview (*fast path if he wants to see Improving in action before committing*)

Prior Cardinal Health History

Bryan Crawford noted you have the last sales activity with Cardinal Health — a board meeting in December. No notes in the vault. Worth knowing if you have a prior contact there before the call.